

IEEE Access 33821 - Team Action Brief

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Bottom line: NO-GO as-is, fixable without new data. Controlled results reproduce (join micro-F1 0.890 on 31 images, VLM 0.923, synthetic 0.95 vs 0.36). What blocks resubmission is prose scope, contradictory claims, and package artifacts. Two revision lines now exist — the first decision is how to merge them.

Scope: Independent audit (Astra, 7 Sept 2026) of the revision work + 12-comment reviewer closeout. Audit base: detached commit `36b9a8e`. Full evidence in branch `validation/audit-20260907-astra`. No production code was changed by the audit.

Latest update — plan complete, first fix landed

- **Implementation plan written** (`IMPLEMENTATION_PLAN.md` in the audit branch): D1-D4 verdicts, all 12 comments specified, package checklist, 7 OPEN items (all human-side). One Astra planning run, ~20% of quota.
- **First fix applied and pushed** (merge branch `revision/access-2026-33821-merge-20260907`, commit `823aef6`): method description now matches the OBB + nearest-pin implementation in both sources. Verified independently, `diff --check` clean.

- **Key finding for T1:** the fork line and the revision line share no git history (duplicated commits split the ancestry), and the fork's patch does not apply cleanly. T1 is hand surgery on `paper-access.tex` plus the 4 artifact files — never a merge or rebase.
- **Pushback resolved:** crossover rerun withdrawn (artifact was present); method fix applied (above); human PDF review stays T7's job.

Where things stand — two revision lines

Line	Base	Contains	Still missing
Bosco branch (revision/ access-2026-33821 @ 36b9a8e + working tree)	Aug revision	Newer experiments: complexity histogram, C242 causal detail, full CI treatment, rebuilt figures, C138 escape, detected-box row	Retitle not locked; no response letter; no highlighted/clean PDFs
Pranavesh fork (review/ieee-access- revision-2026-09 @ 10c1b92 , Sept 3)	July main	Structural retitle, VLM recast, ablation + per- drafter tables, 12- point response draft with change index	Stale base; no compiled PDFs; no template conversion; no device table

Fork facts verified deterministically: change diff is byte-exact, tau multipliers (0.62/0.30/0.20) and pixel clamps match code, drafter cell counts and ablation numbers match committed JSONs. Earlier contributions (PR #2 harness, PR #4 experiments, PR #75 closed draft, PR #77 layout integrated via #78) are retained infrastructure, not the live revision question.

Decisions for the team (discuss first)

- **D1 — Merge direction.** Proposal: rebase the fork onto the revision branch, keeping the newer experiments and figures where they supersede carried-forward values.
- **D2 — Retitle lock.** Proposal: accept "Structural Circuit Netlists" (the fork implements it; the plan recommended it).
- **D3 — Response starting point.** Proposal: fork draft as the base, converted into the IEEE template, plus the missing author-verification rows.
- **D4 — PDF ownership.** Proposal: one owner builds both layouts + highlighted copy and visually checks every page before anyone calls the package done.

Reviewer closeout — status, fix, and who already has it

Status describes the Bosco branch. "Fork" = whether Pranavesh's branch already contains the fix.

Comment	Status	The fix	Fork
R1-1 single corpus / N=31	Partial	Descriptive within-corpus wording; no generalization claims	Partial
R1-2 complex-device pins	Gap	Capability table (evaluated vs generic-guess vs export)	Partial
R1-3 manual thresholds	Partial	Correct sign; concede extremes untested	Partial
R1-4 no OCR / not simulatable	Gap	Scope sentence in abstract + intro + conclusion	Yes
R1-5 small circuits	Partial	Dense-bus/multilayer limit sentence	Partial
R1-6 memristor cites	Gap	Polite decline paragraph in response	Yes
R2-1 stats / roadmap	Partial	Roadmap paragraph; fix "same accuracy"	Partial
R2-2 VLM oracle / cost	Gap	Conditional wording; drop cost multiples	Yes
R2-3 SPICE title	Gap	Retitle + running heads; rebuild PDF	Yes
R2-4 crossover merges	Partial	Full tradeoff; GT-box vs detector-miss wording	Partial
R2-5 ablation	Partial	Caption sign + scope; unclip Table p.6	Yes
R2-6 one scalar limit	Closed	None — keep disclosure as-is	Yes

Shared language fixes everywhere: nonsignificance is not equivalence; no global short-free guarantee; GT-box results do not prove end-to-end dominance.

Task list (proposed owners — confirm together)

#	Task	Proposed owner	Blocked by
T1	Rebase fork onto revision branch; resolve conflicts keeping newer experiments	Bosco + Pranavesh	D1
T2	Lock retitle across title, heads, abstract, intro, conclusion	Bosco (decision)	D2
T3	Device capability table; fix switch-export wording	Assignee TBD	D1
T4	Response letter in IEEE template from fork draft, incl. R1-6 decline	Assignee TBD	D3
T5	VLM + stats prose pass (conditional wording, roadmap paragraph)	Assignee TBD	D1
T6	Numbers pass (ablation sign, reach label, config ledger, Otsu kept)	Assignee TBD	D1
T7	Rebuild both PDF layouts + highlighted copy; visual page check	Assignee TBD	D4, T1-T6
T8	Author verification: byline, affiliations, ORCIDs, bios, funding, consent	All	—

Numbers to keep straight

- Join 0.890 (418/37/66) reproduced on all 31; perfect-wire 0.8898 — rounds same, not identical.
- 0.9755 = dedup 10°/18px config; mandated 12°/8px gives 0.9726. Label each table.
- Keep Otsu 0.789 (fresh rerun); do not substitute 0.828.

- VLM 0.923, 21/31 exact, 14/15 small — recomputed, CIs match.
- Reach sweep is macro 0.895–0.903 (not 0.898–0.903). Detected-box join 0.247 stays provisional.

Sources

Full evidence in branch `validation/audit-20260907-astra`: `VALIDATION_NOTES.md` (findings F1–F16), `REVIEWER_CLOSEOUT.md`, `PHASE1_ASSESSMENT.md`, scratch reruns (pytest 495 passed, join/synthetic/wire/CI JSONs). Audit base `36b9a8e`; decision letter Access-2026-33821 (13 Aug 2026).